TIER I ADOPTION NOTICE

Software Communications Architecture (SCA) Version 4.1 (SCA-V4.1) was adopted on August 20, 2015 for use by the Department of Defense (DoD). Proposed changes by DoD activities must be submitted to the DoD Adopting Activity: Joint Tactical Networking Center (JTNC) Communications Standards Team. Information regarding this technical standard, including copies of the latest revision, may be obtained electronically from https://www.jtnc.mil/Resources-Catalog/Category/16990/sca/.

The Software Communications Architecture (SCA) Version 4.1 is published by the Joint Tactical Networking Center (JTNC) through partnership with industry partners via the Wireless Innovation Forum (WInnF). The WInnF is a global organization that promotes radio communications and systems standards and technologies.

This architecture was developed to assist in the development of Software Defined Radio (SDR) communication systems, capturing the benefits of recent technology advances which are expected to greatly enhance interoperability of communication systems and reduce development and deployment costs. The architecture is also applicable to other embedded, distributed-computing applications such as Communications Terminals or Electronic Warfare (EW). The SCA has been structured to:

1. Provide for portability of applications software between different SCA implementations
2. Leverage commercial standards to reduce development cost
3. Reduce software development time through the ability to reuse design modules
4. Build on evolving commercial frameworks and architectures

The SCA is deliberately designed to meet commercial application requirements as well as those of military applications. Since the SCA is intended to become a self-sustaining standard, a wide cross-section of industry has been invited to participate in the development and validation of the SCA. The SCA is not a system specification but an implementation independent set of rules that constrain the design of systems to achieve the objectives listed above.

The Core Framework (CF) defines the essential "core" set of open software interfaces and profiles that provide for the deployment, management, interconnection, and intercommunication of software application components in an embedded, distributed-computing communication system. In this sense, all interfaces defined in the SCA are part of the CF.

The SCA Version 4.1 Test Suite (STS) is a software application developed by the JTNC Test and Evaluation Laboratory (JTEL) which assesses compliance of an SDR set against the SCA Specification Version 4.1. The STS is publicly available through the Joint Communications Marketplace (JCM). The STS enables DoD and SDR developers to perform their own tailored product conformance tests to meet SCA requirements. To download the STS, access the following URL - https://jtnc.experience.crmforce.mil/JTNC/s/jtel.

For access to any JTNC non-publicly available standards information, a JCM account along with proof of US citizenship is required. Individuals must follow the steps below to register for a JCM account prior to being given access to any of these materials.

1. Navigate to https://jtnc.experience.crmforce.mil/JTNC/s/register.
2. Fill in your email and subsequent code to start the registration process.
3. If registering for the first time, fill in the requested information.

NOTES:

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a. Business email addresses are required
b. Non-Government individuals will need to provide a CAGE code
c. Current access is US only
d. Government individuals will need to provide organization info

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b. Proof of citizenship will be satisfied by submitting a visit request to the destination identified as part of the registration process – you will receive an email containing the necessary information for submitting a visit request.

Custodians:
Army – JTNC
Navy – AS
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Adopting Activity:
Army – JTNC
(Project MOSS-2024-011)

Reviewing Activities:
Army – AC, AVN, CR6
Navy – EC, NM
Air Force – 10, 11, 20
OSD – SE

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